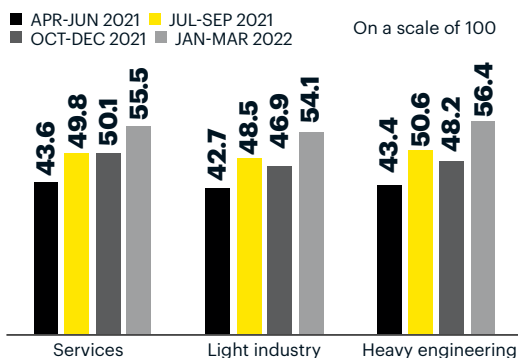


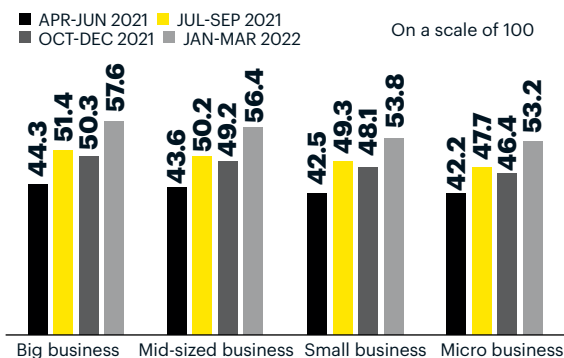
HEAVY METAL

Heavy engineering sector shows the highest confidence



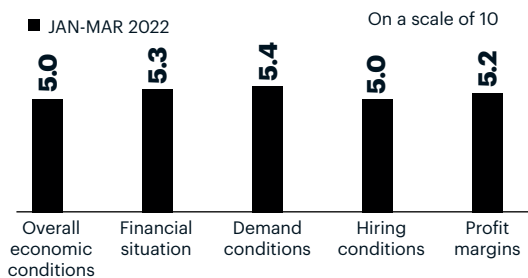
BIG SHOW

Big business is the most confident of performance in Jan-March 2022

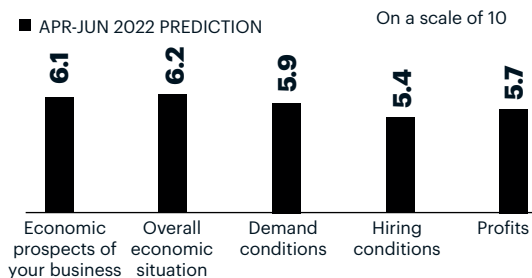


Big business = turnover > ₹500 crore; Mid-sized = turnover ₹100-500 crore; Small = turnover < ₹100 crore; Micro = turnover < ₹5 crore

Businesses were most confident about the return of demand conditions in the quarter gone by...



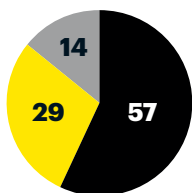
...and they are even more optimistic about the next quarter, despite obvious challenges



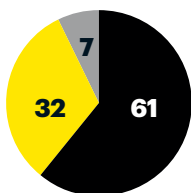
44 |

WHAT'S COMING

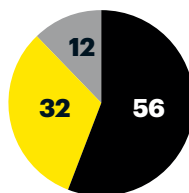
Do you expect the rise in fuel prices to impact your business negatively in the next quarter?



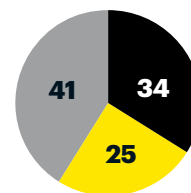
Do you expect to raise prices of your products/services because of the rising inflation?



Is the conflict in Ukraine impacting your business negatively?



Do you believe that Covid-19 is a thing of the past, and will not impact your business in the next quarter?



Source: The BT-C Fore Business Confidence Survey conducted between March 30 and April 12, 2022, of 500 CEOs or CFOs representing various industries and company sizes across Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru, Kolkata, Chandigarh, Lucknow, Nagpur, Kochi, Visakhapatnam and Bhubaneswar

ember when the Omicron wave set in. However, this had been dented considerably due to the results of the war, especially on inflation where rising prices have upset consumption baskets, which in turn has the potential to slow down the investment cycle. The uncertainty will further dent confidence." Dipti Deshpande, Principal Economist, CRISIL Ltd., points to the challenges for the next fiscal: "As we go into fiscal 2023, cost pressures show no signs of abating despite weak demand. Rising cost pressures emerging from global supply chain dis-

ruptions and high international commodity prices from the Russia-Ukraine conflict will add to the inflationary impulse in fiscal 2023... As the economy opens further and demand conditions improve, core inflation is expected to rise with pressure from the services segment as well. The rise in CPI inflation therefore is expected to be broader based across components."

The hardest hit by these challenges would be, not the Nifty 50 or BSE 30, but the micro, small and medium enterprises or MSMEs. Tushar Sood, Founder and CEO of